Sai Shashank GP

Ph.D. Student | University of Alberta
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Education

- **Ph.D. in Computing Science** Sep 2025 – Present
  University of Alberta *Edmonton, Canada*
  - Supervisor: Levi Santana de Lelis
- **Bachelor & Master of Technology in Electrical Engineering** Nov 2020 – May 2025
  Indian Institute of Technology, Madras *Chennai, India*
  - Supervisor: Balaraman Ravindran

Professional Experience

- **Google DeepMind India** Sep 2024 – Feb 2025
  Student Researcher
  - Studied the reliability and sample efficiency of SOTA LLMs to generate executable reward functions for RL frameworks (like PPO) to optimize for.
- **TCS Research** May 2024 – Jul 2024
  Research Intern
  - Studied the sample efficiency of offline RL algorithms (like IQL) in controlling joint HVAC - EV charger systems to minimize power consumption.
- **Hixaa Technologies** Dec 2021 – Jan 2022
  Engineering Trainee
  - Developed UI for a industrial-grade parking guidance system that allows the truck driver to see the real-time alignment of silo and container.

Publications

- In Submission
  - **How Should We Search in Neural Language Spaces? A Study on Test-Time Search**
    Sai Shashank GP, Yanze Song, Matthew Macfarlane, Wenhao Li, Clément Bonnet, Levi Lelis
    Under review
- Preprint
  - **Active Foundational Models for Fault Diagnosis of Electric Motors**
    Sriram Anbalagan, **Sai Shashank GP**, Deepesh Agarwal, Balasubramanian Natarajan, Babji Srinivasan
    arXiv:2311.15516, 2023.

Honors and Awards

- Computing Science Graduate Recruitment Award 2025
- Young Research Fellowship 2022 – 2023
- Kishore Vaigyanik Protsahan Yojana Fellowship 2019 – 2020

Teaching

- Teaching Assistant – University of Alberta
  - CMPUT365: Introduction to Reinforcement Learning — Fall 2026; Winter 2026; Fall 2025
- Teaching Assistant – Indian Institute of Technology Madras
  - CS6700: Reinforcement Learning — Winter 2024; Winter 2025
  - EE4371: Data Structures and Algorithms — Fall 2024
  - EE2703: Applied Programming Lab — Fall 2023

Service

- Social Volunteering – Shiksha Prayas NGO — 2023 – 2024
  - Mentored underprivileged high school students in their studies and career choices
  - Organized social events for middle school students centered around general knowledge and current affairs to raise awareness
- TechFest Organizing – Shaastra, IIT Madras — 2023
  - Organized competitions and presentations centered around electronics and hardware engineering.
  - Brought in sponsors like Micron and Bajaj.
- Academic Reviewing – RLC 2026 (RLBrew Workshop)

Skills

- **Programming Languages:** Python (PyTorch, JAX), C, C++17